Purpose:

- To relieve pain and congestion
- To promote suppuration
- To provide warmth and comfort
- To promote healing
- To decrease muscle tone and to soften the exudates
- To relieve retention of urine



Articles required:

- Hot water bag with cover
- Boiled water in a jug and cold water in another jug
- Duster
- Lotion Thermometer
- Towel
- Vaseline (or) moisturizing lotion

Indications:

- Local congestion
- Muscle spasm
- Fatigue
- Pain

Contra Indications:

- Heat is not used in malignancies, because heat increases, the metabolism of both the normal and abnormal cells
- Heat is not used for client with impaired kidney, heart and lung functions
- Heat should not be applied to actually inflamed areas. E.g: Acute tooth abscess. the heat may cause them to rupture the surrounding tissues
- Heat should not be applied on the clients with paralysis, weakness and debilitated clients, because they have impaired perceptions and they may not be responding to hot application resulting in burns
- Heat should not be applied, when there is oedema, associated with venous or lymphatic disease
- Heat should not be applied on clients with metabolic disorders. It may increase the hazards of tissues damage
- Heat should not be applied on clients with high temperature
- Heat should not be applied to very young and very old people because of the risk of tissue burns



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